

Student's Assessment Number _____

**THE UNITED REPUBLIC OF TANZANIA
NATIONAL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL OF TANZANIA
FORM TWO NATIONAL ASSESSMENT PILOT**

012

HISTORY

(For Both School and Private Students)

Duration: 2:30 Hours

Year: 2026

Instructions

1. This paper consists of sections A, B and C with a total of **ten (10)** questions.
2. Answer **all** questions in sections A, B and C.
3. Section A and C carries **fifteen (15)** marks each and section B carries **seventy (70)** marks.
4. All writing must be in **blue** or **black** ink.
5. Communication devices and any unauthorised materials are **not** allowed in the assessment room.
6. Write your **Assessment Number** at the top right corner of every page.

FOR ASSESSOR'S USE ONLY		
QUESTION NUMBER	SCORE	ASSESSOR'S INITIALS
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
TOTAL		
CHECKER'S INITIALS		



SECTION A (15 Marks)

Answer **all** questions in this section.

1. For each of the items (i) – (x), choose the correct answer from the given alternatives and write its letter in the box provided.
- (i) How does the Evolution Theory help in explaining human origins?
- A Explains gradual biological development over time
 - B Provides lessons for future generations
 - C Shows how historical events followed each other
 - D Explains the creation of humans during the early times
-
- (ii) The following are the functions of oral traditions **except**:
- A transmitting knowledge about cultural beliefs and skills.
 - B keeping and preserving ancient historical objects.
 - C entertaining people during various cultural activities.
 - D encouraging people to appreciate and preserve their culture.
-
- (iii) How did nomadic pastoralists in pre-colonial African societies adapt to their environment?
- A Combined animal keeping and crop cultivation
 - B Specialised in processing iron tools and weapons
 - C Practised crop rotation and shifting cultivation
 - D Moved from one place to another in search of water and pasture
-
- (iv) Why did Ghana Empire rise and expand during the pre-colonial period?
- A It had good leaders such as Mansa Kankan Musa
 - B It possessed the golden stool which strengthened unity
 - C It had efficient administrative system and military strength
 - D It had experienced soldiers who used short stabbing spears
-
- (v) The following were the aims of pre-colonial education in Africa **except**:
- A teaching the young about honesty and integrity.
 - B promoting peace and insecurity in the society.
 - C imparting knowledge, skills and values to the young.
 - D developing children's character and intellectual abilities.
-
- (vi) Why were interactions important before the coming of the Europeans in Africa?
- A They initiated the Portuguese's voyages of discovery
 - B They led to the underdevelopment of Africa
 - C They encouraged trade and the rise of certain states
 - D They stimulated the occurrence of Boer Trek
-

- (vii) How was salt used in pre-colonial Africa?
A Serving as a food ingredient and a preservative
B Making jewellery and decorative materials
C Manufacturing various ornaments
D Tying bundles of firewood and tethering animals
- (viii) The following were the effects of Ngoni migration **except**:
A emergence of social disturbances due to frequent wars.
B intermarriages between the indigenous people and the Ngoni.
C rise and expansion of Songhay kingdom.
D decline of agricultural production.
- (ix) Which feature best describes about the Early Stone Age tools in Africa?
A Simple and crude
B Complex in design and heavy
C Crude and complex in design
D Simple and complex in design
- (x) Why did *Mfecane* emerge in the 19th century?
A Because of the occurrence of the *Kaffir* wars
B Due to the expulsion of Shaka from South Africa
C Because of population growth in Zululand
D Due to the arrival of Portuguese sailors in South Africa

2. Match the descriptions associated with production and social organization in pre-colonial Africa in **List A** with the correct terms in **List B** by writing the letter of the correct response below the corresponding item number in the table provided.

List A		List B	
(i)	A system where land and other resources are owned collectively by the community.	A	Feudalism
(ii)	An activity that involves crop cultivation and livestock keeping.	B	Economic production
(iii)	A system based on forced labour and ownership of people as property.	C	Mode of production
(iv)	A process of producing goods and services to meet human needs.	D	Slavery
(v)	A system where lords grant land to subjects in exchange for labour or loyalty.	E	Basketry
		F	Communalism
		G	Agriculture
		H	Productive forces

Answers

List A	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)
List B					

SECTION B (70 Marks)

Answer **all** questions in this section.

3. Briefly explain the following terms:

- (i) Trans-Saharan Trade

- (ii) Interaction

(iii) *Mfecane*

(iv) *Jihad*

4. Arrange the following historical events associated with the origins of human beings in a chronological order by writing their roman numbers below the corresponding item number in the table provided.

- (i) During the Early Stone Age, humans obtained food by gathering.
- (ii) Humans domesticated crops and animals.
- (iii) Food security led to population growth and formation of empires.
- (iv) Humans learnt how to make fire by hand-drilling a stick on a dry wood.
- (v) The use of iron tools helped to improve agriculture and enhanced food security.

Answers

1 st	2 nd	3 rd	4 th	5 th

5. Sort the explanations in the box into characteristics of humans during the Early Stone Age and Iron Age and write the answer in the spaces provided.

Ended slave trade, Involved in trade, Lived in caves, Gathered fruits, Practised smelting, Discovered fire.
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Early Stone Age	Iron Age
(i) _____ _____	(i) _____ _____
(ii) _____ _____	(ii) _____ _____

6. Describe four limitations of oral traditions.

- (i) _____

- (ii) _____

- (iii) _____

- (iv) _____

7. The discovery of fire changed the lives of human beings during the Middle Stone Age. Evaluate four benefits of this discovery to humans during that period.

- (i) _____

- (ii) _____

- (iii) _____

- (iv) _____

8. Outline four characteristics of communalism.

- (i) _____

- (ii) _____

- (iii) _____

Student's Assessment Number _____

(iv) _____

9. Briefly explain four factors that contributed to the rise of Mali empire.

(i) _____

(ii) _____

(iii) _____

(iv) _____

SECTION C (15 Marks)

Answer question **ten (10)**.

10. “The use of iron tools brought many advantages to the people during the pre-colonial period.” Justify this statement by giving five points.

Student's Assessment Number _____

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal grey lines across its entire width, providing a template for handwriting practice or general note-taking. The margins are consistent on all sides.